PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

Suzuki Jimny LJ series

1970–1981 · LJ10 · LJ20 · LJ50 · LJ80

BOXYTRUCKS

CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- [ ] **Rust in sills, corner posts and floors**
  These are 45- to 55-year-old steel bodies. LJ80 specialist LJ80.de stocks repair panels for the corner posts, sills, side panels and footwell floors, which hints at where they rot. Probe those areas and the frame before anything else. On one BaT 1972 LJ20, the battery tray had a patch panel and rust.
- [ ] **Which LJ is it really?**
  Engines were swapped and bodies updated. The LJ10 has an air-cooled twin and a horizontal-slat grille. The LJ20 has a water-cooled twin and a vertical grille. The LJ50 has a three-cylinder two-stroke, and the LJ80 has a four-stroke four. Count the cylinders and check the cooling system.
- [ ] **Two-stroke health**
  On LJ10, LJ20 and LJ50 trucks, a two-stroke that won't idle or smokes heavily may need a full rebuild, and engine parts are scarcer than for the LJ80. Ask what has been done and how the engine is lubricated (confirm in manual).
- [ ] **Leaf springs and bushings**
  Sagging springs and perished bushings are normal at this age. LJ80.de still sells complete front and rear LJ80 spring sets, bushing kits and shackle plates, so it's fixable.
- [ ] **Brakes are drums all round**
  Every LJ has four-wheel drum brakes. Check for seized wheel cylinders, a leaking master cylinder and contaminated shoes before driving one anywhere.
- [ ] **Title and import paperwork**
  Suzuki didn't sell the LJ in the US itself; LJ20s came in through an independent importer as the Brute. Most US trucks are later imports, like the LJ20 on BaT that was sold new in Australia. Make sure the title and import paperwork match the chassis.
- [ ] **Originality affects value**
  Original LJ10 and LJ20 trucks are rare. BaT results show restored LJ20s and early Jimnys selling at about $10,000–11,500, ahead of rougher examples.

IS IT THE REAL THING?

- [ ] **Engine**
  LJ10: air-cooled 359 cc twin. LJ20: water-cooled 359 cc twin. LJ50/SJ10: 539 cc three-cylinder two-stroke. LJ80/SJ20: 797 cc four-stroke four.
- [ ] **Grille**
  The LJ10 has horizontal slots; Suzuki says the LJ20's vertical eight-slot grille became the Jimny's signature face.

- [ ] **Spare wheel**
  Japanese kei trucks kept the spare inside to stay under 3 m; export trucks and the LJ20F carried it outside.

NOTES

From the full guide at https://boxytrucks.com/models/suzuki/lj-series/, with sources. Recalls follow the VIN: check at nhtsa.gov/recalls. General information only, not a professional inspection; see boxytrucks.com/about/disclaimer/. © BoxyTrucks